

# ART OF THE BOOK OF THE BOOK OF THE BOOK OF THE BOOK

EXHIBITION RECEPTION: TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 30, 2010 FROM 6PM TO 8PM  
THE COOPER UNION, SCHOOL OF ART, FOUNDATION BUILDING 2ND FL LOBBY  
3RD AVENUE AT 7TH STREET, NEW YORK CITY, NOVEMBER 22 TO DECEMBER 4

2010

## 1.1

### An Index

#### Philipp Carlos Adrian

Your name is in this book. You can find every possible start of every possible page of every book if you look for it. Any possible word you can think of is indexed in this book by its first five letters. In a way, this book is an index of the "Library of Babel" by Jorge Luis Borges. Readers are invited to mark the text as evidence of their discoveries.

## 2.1

### Fortune Glass

#### Sooyeon Kim

Inspired by fortune cookies, this book portrays my anticipation of and excitement in unweaving the concealed messages. The concept of time is symbolized by the sand in the hourglass. The written messages reveal themselves as the sand falls through the glass, like the act of breaking a fortune cookie after moments of waiting.

## 2.2

### Phases

#### Yarminiah Rosa

The world of this audio book contains vivid fragments of various stories in the voices of eight different people from inside and outside my family who I interviewed or recorded over the course of the past year.

## 2.3

### A City of Words

#### Hannah Guerrero

Walking through the city overwhelms me due to the crowds, sounds and traffic, but specifically because of the constant bombardment of words. Everywhere the eye falls is yet another message and reading them is completely unavoidable. The text block has a profusion of words on every surface and on every page. As the city has many corners to turn and ways to travel, the book also has many entrance points that open onto even more words on every surface, sign, and in every shop window.

## 3.1

### Coffee Table Book

#### Willia Nasatir

The elegant and oversized coffee table book is a well-known signifier of success in art. This catalog of influential coffee table designs, illustrated on hand-marbled paper and covered in birch, opens into a freestanding coffee table that provides its own support for reading.

## 3.2

### Big Sur

#### Willia Nasatir

The changing horizon of Big Sur, California, inspired this series of photographs. The design, framing the images in transparent Plexiglas, creates the feeling that each page is floating. The cover changes color based on movement and exposure to light.

## 4.1

### Largess

#### Stephen Cassidy

*The Torrents of Spring* was Ernest Hemingway's first novel. In it, a young writer interrupts his own text and challenges the conventions of publishing. The four leather-bound books in this set give weight to the four points in this novel where Hemingway addresses his reader directly in an acerbic, brilliant, and egomaniacal manner.

## 4.2

### Faulty Mirror

#### Maria Vlasova

A book of two books. A photo essay and an original text. From a plastic bag full of photographs I pull out one. I have seen it many times before; I know it well. In it two women stand side by side in a sunlit garden, their heads tilted toward each other. They wear matching swimming suits. Each woman holds a child in her arms. They smile; their picture is about to be taken. One is my mother; to the left, her fraternal twin. My mother holds me; her sister holds my cousin. We were born six days apart. Another character in this scene is our grandmother. She is taking the picture. With a family photograph as a jumping off point the text attempts to investigate international, domestic and internal paradoxes found in this image.

## 5.1

### Secret Spaces

#### Melissa Mote

A seemingly innocuous lump of black fur opens to reveal several layers of hand-dyed felt that presents an exploration of voids or "black holes." Peeling back the layers becomes a process in which the viewer can participate, eventually finding the "secret" at the object's center. These materials create the illusion of a deep space that turns an intangible space into a physical object that references the unreal.

## 5.2

### Cavern

#### Melissa Mote

A panther's head with a cavernous mouth spews a snakeskin tongue. The tongue unrolls to reveal a painted scroll. The imagery on the scroll shows several abstracted bodies entering and exiting voids of the deepest black, surrounded by prisms that become a key, unlocking light and heat.

## 6.1

### Anatomy of the Book

**Sooyeon Kim**

The deconstructed book gives the reader access to a beautiful and delicate world that is usually hidden. By allowing the elements of a book to remain in parts, the reader can access information about how a book is constructed and imagine how these elements combine into a whole.

## 7.1

### A Catalogue of Flyers

**Philipp Carlos Adrian**

My book collects the 4 x 6 inch flyers that I have been given over the past three months as I walked the streets of New York City. Ordered by date and bound in book form, the flyers create a diary of the convergence of numerous cultures at the intersection of the stranger who receives the flyers with the strangers who distribute them.

## 7.2

### Tristram

**Alexander Rocine**

William S. Burroughs and Brion Gysin suggested in *Minutes to Go* that new writings could be created from previous texts using the "cut up method" to re-order the words of the original author. My adaptation of Edwin Arlington Robinson's *Tristram* re-interprets the cut-up method by weaving together strips cut from pages of his book. The weaving of the pages reveals the piecemeal nature of language, as the original meaning is destroyed and a new text emerges.

## 8.1

### The Book

**Stefanie Kolb**

Opening a book, we expect to find information, distraction, and inspiration, even the possibility of finding ourselves carried away by our imagination. We take it for granted that all this can happen through an encounter with a book. As we don't pay enough attention to the medium itself anymore—how the book is made, materials that are used—my project seeks to return the book to the status of a beautiful object. The book is allowed to contain something other than the expected content. The reader must slit the plain white pages to access the text, which defy her expectation. She will find herself immersed in a blurred, unreadable text about the art of bookbinding and book design.

## 8.2

### Traveling

**Stefanie Kolb**

Since I have been a child, traveling has always been a matter of course to me, first with my parents, and later on my own. I have traveled to 26 countries all around the world. For me it is one of the best ways to learn, to grow personally, and to discover more about yourself. This development is the result of your experiences, the people you meet, and the challenges you encounter and face. Nevertheless, traveling is not so one sided; it is a multi-directional current, a flow and exchange of experiences between the traveler and the places she is visiting. For this reason, I designed my book to be accessible from two sides. The holes cut through the pages are not just indicators of the amount of time I stayed in a country but also represent the exchange of experiences. From one side, the book functions as an information graphic, showing how many countries I have traveled to, how often I've gone, and how long I stayed there. Turning the book upside down and paging through from the other side allows the reader to access a more personal travelogue through short anecdotes devoted to each country.

## 9.1

### Word-Cards

**Alexander Rocine**

A deck of word-cards. A poem in potential. A string of random words that can be assembled at will using the deck. The face of each card imprinted with a different word. Cards are dealt, a poem is randomly constructed. On the card back, an invented glyph for the idea of Word.

## 9.2

### Four Tamales

**Hannah Guerrero**

Through four generations of Guerrero women, the green corn tamale has been a staple food of my family. The first tamale relates closely to my Great-Grandmother's generation where the materials used to make the book are the same materials used to make tamales. As time passes and traditions evolve through the generations the materials evolve to match. Instead of real corn husk, silk is used instead, and the whole corn kernels featured in the first tamale disintegrate into flour. The third tamale represents my aunt who wanted to trace her roots back and grow her own corn specifically to make my Nana's green corn tamales. The fourth tamale represents my generation and comes from the processed food aisle of a supermarket. It is shrink-wrapped in plastic and advertised as "hand-crafted."

## 10.1

### Midland and Mallard's Landing:

#### A Tale of Two Suburbs

**Stephen Cassidy**

Midland and Mallard's Landing are two suburban neighborhoods at opposite ends of the economic continuum between neglectful decay and conspicuous consumption. Images of newly constructed mansions in Mallard's Landing are overlaid with the scratch-off paint used for lottery games. Atop that silver surface are printed images of houses from the once grand but now heavily blighted community of Midland. By scratching away the paint that carries the houses of Midland to reveal the mansions of Mallard's Landing, the reader constructs a relationship between the two neighborhoods.

## 11.1

### Book of Red Ants

**Daniel Harrington**

*Book of Red Ants* is composed of a series of four nesting ant farms made of Plexiglas, and filled with a transparent gelatin that provides both sustenance and tunneling-ground for its occupants—namely, four colonies of the Harvester Ant. Harvester Ants were chosen to inhabit this structure both for their adaptability (most ant species cannot survive in the gelatin compound) and for their beautiful red color. *Book of Red Ants* is an exploration of the city as a living organism, its peculiar mechanisms and pulse. Each 'leaf' is designed to suggest the urban framework as a series of 'worlds within worlds' that appear to overlap and influence one another. Singly, however, the colonies are distinct entities. While possibly comprehending the existence of neighboring colonies, each stratum cannot enter or associate with the other. Only the idea of contact exists here.

## 11.2

### CANTOS

**Daniel Harrington**

This monumental organic book, based on *The Cantos of Ezra Pound*, brings together pages made from live moss, finely detailed ink drawings, and collage elements. It is currently in progress and will remain unfinished for some time.

## 11.3

### N. L. C. O. W. G.

**Daniel Harrington**

*'To write a book is to write one's own epitaph.'*

*N.L.C.O.W.G.* is composed of three interlocking elements: First, a wooden 'spine,' cut by hand and hand-planed; second, two pieces of hand-carved marble from an earlier and indeterminate era form the 'covers' of the book; finally, there is a text block consisting of graphite rubbings that form a brief poem. Ratios of depth and scale (*Is this a casket?* Perhaps it is *only a cradle?*) were dictated by the dimensions of the marble, a cover-frontispiece that was once the headstone of a deceased infant. Shifting this stone aside reveals the naked text, featuring a peculiar poem. Removing this vulnerable and now unclad codex reveals the back cover—a second former headstone. This stone, owing to its size, has been embedded into wood and dictates the dimensions of the folios resting upon it.

## 12.1

### The Optical Illusion

**Maria Vlasova**

A 16mm film animation brings to life the text of short stories by Daniil Kharmis, a Russian absurdist of the early 20th century. Stop motion activated text and image collages provide an interpretation of Kharmis' reinvented narrative structure.

## 13.1

### Martha

**Yarminiah Rosa**

This book is a performance based on the elderly character Martha from my one-woman show, *A Strong Home*. Its form and the process of its creation pose a challenge to the relationship between the reader and the text. In order to experience the book, the reader must engage with the character Martha, who will literally weave the book throughout the performance.

### The Book in Motion

**Professor Margaret Morton**

*The Book in Motion* presents student books from previous years as an interactive website. The project was supported by a Durbin Faculty Grant. School of Art graduate Christhian Diaz build the website. [www.thebookinmotion.com](http://www.thebookinmotion.com)

The Art of the Book class

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